

BECOMING A HUNTER DEEPCALLER...

AS A LEVEL 1 CHARACTER

- Gain all the traits in the Core Hunter Deepcaller Traits table.
- Gain the Hunter Deepcaller's level 1 features, which are listed in the Hunter Deepcaller Features table.

HUNTER DEEPCALLER CLASS FEATURES

As a Hunter Deepcaller, you gain the following class features when you reach the specified Hunter Deepcaller levels. These features are listed in the Hunter Deepcaller Features table.

LEVEL 1: ELDRITCH COMPREHENSION

Through occult rituals, you have expanded your mind beyond mortal limits, gaining the ability to comprehend eldritch passages and speak words no sane creature was meant to understand. These forbidden words allow you to read and perform Rites.

See at the end of this class description for the rules on Rite-performing. The information below details how you use those rules with Hunter Deepcaller Rites, which appear in Appendix B “The Book of the Deepcaller” And Appendix C “Hushed Whispers”.

Whispers. You know two Whispers of your choice. Whispers are lesser fragments of forbidden knowledge that are not written in the Book of the Deepcaller and must be memorized.

Whenever you gain a Hunter Deepcaller level, you can replace one Whisper you know with another Whisper of your choice.

When you reach Hunter Deepcaller levels 4 and 10, you learn another Whisper of your choice, as shown in the Whispers column of the Hunter Deepcaller Features table.

Strains. The Hunter Deepcaller Features table shows how many Strains you have to perform your Rites of Levels 1–5. The table also shows the level of those Strains, all of which are the same level. You regain all expended Strains when you finish a Short or Long Rest.

For example, when you are a level 5 Hunter Deepcaller, you have two Level 3 Strains. To perform a Level 1 Rite, you must spend one of those Strains, and the Rite is performed as a Level 3 Rite.

The Book of the Deepcaller. Your Book of the Deepcaller contains the forbidden passages needed to perform Hunter Deepcaller Rites of level 1-5. You do not prepare these Rites. Any Hunter Deepcaller Rite in your book is available for you to perform, provided you have a Strain of a high enough level to perform it.

As your Strain level increases, your mind becomes capable of comprehending deeper and more dangerous passages within the book. You can perform any Hunter Deepcaller Rite of a level equal to or lower than your current Strain level.

For example, when your Strain level is 3, you can perform Hunter Deepcaller Rites of Levels 1, 2, and 3, but not Rites of Levels 4 or 5.

Rite Performing Ability. Intelligence is the Rite Performing ability for your Hunter Deepcaller Rites.

Performing a Rite. Unless otherwise stated, performing a Rite requires you to hold a Book of the Deepcaller in one hand and speak the Rite's words aloud. Each time you perform a Rite, you suffer 2 Madness, unless a feature or effect says otherwise.

Performing a Whisper. Whispers are an exception to the normal rules for performing Rites. Performing a Whisper requires only a hushed recitation of its words. You do not need a Book of the Deepcaller to perform a Whisper, and performing a Whisper does not cause you to suffer Madness unless an effect says otherwise.

Break the Limits of Your Mind. If you perform a Rite using a Strain level higher than your current Strain level, you suffer Madness equal to your maximum Sanity immediately after the Rite is performed. This is not recommended.

LEVEL 1: FRACTURING MIND

Every time you level up suffer 2 Madness and permanently gain 1 max Sanity.

LEVEL 2: BRACED MIND

As an Action, you steady your mind through an esoteric rite, forcing forbidden knowledge back into shape.

When you do so, you suffer 1 Madness and regain a number of expended Strains equal to half your maximum number of Strains, rounded up.

Once you use this feature, you cannot use it again until you finish a Long Rest.

LEVEL 2: VAILED TRUTH

You no longer suffer Madness from performing Level 1 Rites unless an effect specifically says so.

LEVEL 3: THE HUNTER ZEALOT PRESTIGE CLASS

At 3rd level, you may enter the Path of the Zealot Prestige Class, abandoning the traditional path of the Deepcaller.

If you choose this Prestige Class, you gain no further features from the Hunter Deepcaller class. Instead, whenever you would gain a Hunter Deepcaller feature, you gain the corresponding feature from the Path of the Zealot Prestige Class.

You lose all Hunter Deepcaller features gained before entering this Prestige Class unless a Zealot feature specifically says otherwise.

The Path of the Zealot Prestige Class is detailed after the Hunter Deepcaller class description.

A Prestige Class is an alternative progression path that replaces your existing class path with a specialized set of abilities.

LEVEL 3: OPENED MIND

As a Bonus Action, you can establish a telepathic link between yourself and up to eight willing creatures you can see within 60 feet.

The link lasts for 1 round (the start of your next round). While linked, each creature may communicate telepathically with the others. When the link is established, each linked creature may contribute once to the conversation. The order is determined by the participants themselves. Once a creature has finished communicating, the next creature may speak.

This communication occurs outside the normal flow of time and does not consume Actions, Bonus Actions, Reactions, or movement.

Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a Short or Long Rest unless you expend a Strain (no action required) to restore your use of it.

LEVEL 4: ABILITY SCORE IMPROVEMENT

You gain the Ability Score Improvement feat (see chapter 4) or another feat of your choice for which you qualify. You gain this feature again at Hunter Deepcaller levels 8, 12, and 16.

LEVEL 5: ENDURED TRUTH

You no longer suffer Madness from performing Level 2 Rites unless an effect specifically says so.

LEVEL 6: OPENED MIND COMBATANT

When you use your Opened Mind feature, you may choose one creature within 60 feet that you can see. The creature must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your Rite Save DC.

On a failed save, you glimpse fragments of its immediate future and perceive its intentions before they unfold.

For the duration of 10 rounds, the chosen creature has Disadvantage on attack rolls against you, and you have Advantage on attack rolls against it.

LEVEL 9: ACCEPTED TRUTH

You no longer suffer Madness from performing Level 3 Rites unless an effect specifically says so.

LEVEL 10: FRAGMENTS OF A ELDRITCH MIND

You have Resistance to Mind damage, and whenever a creature deals Mind damage to you, that creature takes the same amount of damage that you take.

LEVEL 11: FORBIDDEN REVELATION

Your studies uncover a fragment of knowledge that few minds can endure. The Book of the Deepcaller begins to reveal hidden passages that were always there, but impossible for you to perceive until now.

Choose one Level 6 Rite. This Rite becomes one of your Forbidden Revelations.

You can perform this Rite once without expending Strain. Once you perform it in this way, you cannot do so again until you finish a Long Rest.

At Hunter Deepcaller levels 13, 15, and 17, the Book reveals another Forbidden Revelation to you. These Revelations must be chosen from Hunter Deepcaller Rites of the following levels:

Level 13: one Level 7 Rite

Level 15: one Level 8 Rite

Level 17: one Level 9 Rite

You can also use a Forbidden Revelation for a 1-5 Level Rite that has the option to use Higher Level Strains. That Rite then becomes the level of which Forbidden Revelation you choose.

Whenever you finish a Long Rest, you may replace all of your Forbidden Revelations with another Hunter Deepcaller Rite of the same level.

You regain all uses of your Forbidden Revelations when you finish a Long Rest.

LEVEL 13: EMBRACED TRUTH

You no longer suffer Madness from performing Level 4 Rites unless an effect specifically says so.

LEVEL 14: GREAT SUMMONING

When you perform Call Lesser Starborn, you can choose to forgo Concentration. If you do, the Rite's duration becomes 10 rounds, and the summoned Lesser Starborn gains Temporary Hit Points equal to your Hunter Deepcaller level + your Intelligence modifier.

In addition, the first time each turn the Lesser Starborn hits a creature affected by your Eldritch Chain of Bolts, the attack deals an extra 1d6 Mind damage.

The first time the Lesser Starborn hits a creature affected by your Eldritch Chain of Bolts, choose one Ability. For as long as that creature remains affected by your Eldritch Chain of Bolts, it has Disadvantage on Ability Checks made using that chosen Ability.

LEVEL 17: ABSOLUTE TRUTH

You no longer suffer Madness from performing Level 5 Rites unless an effect specifically says so.

LEVEL 19: EPIC BOON

You gain an Epic Boon feat (see chapter 4) or another feat of your choice for which you qualify.

LEVEL 20: ELDRITCH MASTERY

When you use your Braced Mind feature, you regain all of your expended Strains instead of only half.

THE DEEPCALLERS RITES

TYPES OF RITES

Each Rite has a type. The types are listed in the Types of Rites table. These categories help describe Rites but have no rules of their own, although some other rules refer to them.

LONGER PERFORMING THAN ONE ACTION

Certain Rites require more Actions to perform. While you perform a Rite with a Performing of two or more Actions, you must take the Rite action on each of your turns until the requirement is met, and you must maintain Concentration (see further down) while you do so.

If your Concentration is broken, the Rite fails, but you don't expend a Strain. To perform the Rite again, you must start over.

RANGE

A Rite's range indicates how far from the performer of the Rite the Rites effect can originate, and the Rites description specifies which part of the effect is limited by the range.

A range usually takes one of the following forms:

Distance. The range is expressed in feet.

Touch. The Rite's effect originates on something, as defined by the Rite, that the performer of the Rite must touch within their reach.

Self. The Rite is performed on the performer self, or emanates from them, as specified in the Rite. If a Rite has movable effects, they aren't restricted by its range unless the Rite's description says otherwise.

DURATION

A Rite's duration is the length the Rite persists after it is performed. A duration typically takes one of the following forms:

Concentration. A duration that requires Concentration follows the Concentration rules. (see further down).

Instantaneous. An instantaneous duration means the Rite's outcome appears only for a moment and then disappears.

Span. A duration that provides a span specifies how many rounds the Rite lasts. While span Rite that you perform is ongoing, you can dismiss it (no action required) if you don't have the Incapacitated condition or it is a Summoning Rite.

CONCENTRATION

Some Rites and other effects require Concentration to remain active, as specified in their descriptions.

If the effect's creator loses Concentration, the effect ends. If the effect has a maximum duration, the effect's description specifies for how many rounds the performer can concentrate on it. The creator can end Concentration at any time (no action required).

The following factors break Concentration.

Another Concentration Effect. You lose Concentration on an effect the moment you start performing a Rite that requires Concentration or activate another effect that requires Concentration.

Damage. If you take damage, you must succeed on a Constitution saving throw to maintain Concentration. The DC equals 10 or half the damage taken (round down), whichever number is higher, up to a maximum DC of 30.

Incapacitated or Dead. Your Concentration ends if you have the Incapacitated condition or you die.

RITE EFFECTS

The effects of a Rite are detailed after its Duration entry. These effects describe exactly what the Rite does, often ignoring the normal laws of nature. Any outcomes beyond those effects are determined by the DM. A Rite's effects typically involve targets, saving throws, Rite attacks, or a combination of the three.

TARGETS

Most Rites require you to choose one or more targets. A Rite's description specifies whether it targets creatures, objects, areas, or something else.

A Clear Path to the Target. To target something with a Rite, you must have a clear path to it. A target behind Total Cover cannot be targeted unless the Rite states otherwise.

Targeting Yourself. If a Rite targets a creature of your choice, you may choose yourself unless the Rite specifies a hostile creature or a creature other than yourself.

Areas of Effect. Some Rites affect an area rather than a specific target. The Rite's description specifies the shape of the affected area, which is typically one of the following: Cone, Cube, Cylinder, Emanation, Line, Sphere. A creature or object within the area is affected as described by the Rite.

Awareness of Being Targeted. Unless a Rite produces an obvious effect, a creature is unaware it was targeted. Effects such as lightning, explosions, or summoned horrors are obvious. More subtle effects, such as reading thoughts or influencing the mind, typically go unnoticed unless the Rite states otherwise.

Invalid Targets. If you perform a Rite on a creature or object that cannot be affected by it, the Rite has no effect on that target. Any Strain spent to perform the Rite is still expended.

If the Rite normally allows a saving throw and has no effect on a successful save, an invalid target appears to have succeeded on its saving throw. Otherwise, you perceive that the Rite had no effect.

SAVING THROWS

Many Rites allow a target to make a saving throw to avoid some or all of their effects. The Rite specifies which ability is used and what happens on a success or failure. The saving throw DC for your Rites is calculated as follows:

Rite Save DC = 8 + your Rite Performing Ability Modifier + your Proficiency Bonus

Your Rite Performing Ability is determined by your class.

RITE ATTACKS

Some Rites require you to make a Rite Attack to determine whether the Rite hits its target. Your Rite Attack modifier is calculated as follows:

Rite Attack Modifier = your Rite Performing Ability Modifier + your Proficiency Bonus

COMBINING RITE EFFECTS

The effects of different Rites stack while their durations overlap. However, the effects of the same Rite do not stack with themselves. If the same Rite affects a target multiple times, only the most potent effect applies. If multiple instances are equally potent, the most recent effect applies. For example, if two Deepcallers perform the same Rite on the same target, the target benefits from only one instance of that Rite unless the Rite specifically states otherwise.

HUNTER ZEALOT

Most Deepcallers seek power through forbidden study, reading from the Book of the Deepcaller and calling upon many Patrons. A Zealot abandons that path. Through blood, fire, and devotion, the Zealot offers the book to a single eldritch being and becomes its living weapon. A Zealot does not search for many truths. A Zealot serves one Truth.

LEVEL 3: BURN THE BOOK

When you enter the Hunter Zealot Prestige Class, your Book of the Deepcaller is destroyed, burned, consumed, and claimed by your new Patron.

You lose all Hunter Deepcaller features gained before entering this Prestige Class unless a Zealot feature specifically says otherwise. You gain no further features from the Hunter Deepcaller class. Instead, whenever you would gain a Hunter Deepcaller feature, you gain the corresponding feature from the Hunter Zealot Prestige Class.

You can no longer perform Rites of Level 2 or higher. You also lose all Rites of Level 2 or higher that you knew or had prepared.

You retain your Rite Performing ability, Rite Save DC, and Rite Attack modifier.

LEVEL 3: CHOSEN OF ONE PATRON

Your new Patron becomes the source of your Zealot features.

You no longer require a Book of the Deepcaller to perform Whispers. The words of your Patron are carved into your mind, blood, and flesh.

LEVEL 3: ZEALOT WHISPERS

You retain the Whispers you knew before entering this Prestige Class.

In addition, when you prepare Whispers, you can choose from both normal Whispers and Level 1 Hunter Deepcaller Rites. A Level 1 Rite prepared in this way becomes a Zealot Whisper for you.

A Zealot Whisper:

- does not require a Book of the Deepcaller,

- does not expend Strain,

- does not cause you to suffer Madness,

- cannot be performed using Higher-Level Strain,

- uses your Rite Save DC and Rite Attack modifier as normal.

You prepare a number of Whispers equal to the number shown for a Hunter Deepcaller of your level, plus one additional Whisper.

LEVEL 3: ZEALOT TRAINING

Your Patron reshapes you for battle.

You gain proficiency with martial weapons.

LEVEL 3: ELDRITCH ARMAMENT

Your devotion allows your Patron to guide your weapon through your body.

When you attack with a weapon with which you have proficiency, you can use your Rite

Performing ability for the attack and damage rolls instead of Strength or Dexterity.

When you hit with such a weapon, you can choose for the weapon to deal its normal damage type or Eldritch Power damage.

LEVEL 3: CARVED ELDRITCH STRIKE

You always have Eldritch Strike prepared. It does not count against the number of Whispers you can prepare.

LEVEL 3: CARVED ARMOR OF AGATHYS

You always have Armor of Agathys prepared. For you, Armor of Agathys is treated as a Whisper. It does not count against the number of Whispers you can prepare.

LEVEL 3: STRAIN OF DEVOTION

You no longer use Strain to perform Rites. Instead, your Strain becomes a weaponized expression of your devotion.

Your Strain progression and maximum Strain level continue to improve as shown in the Hunter Deepcaller table. However, you can spend Strain only on Zealot features.

You gain the following ways to spend Strain:

Patron's Blow. Once per turn, when you hit a creature with a weapon attack or Eldritch Strike, you can expend one Strain to deal extra Eldritch Power damage to the target.

The extra damage equals 1d8 per level of the Strain expended.

Patron's Ward. When you take damage, you can take a Reaction and expend one Strain to reduce the damage by 1d8 per level of the Strain expended + your Rite Performing ability modifier.

Patron's Step. As a Bonus Action, you can expend one Strain to teleport up to 10 feet per level of the Strain expended to an unoccupied space you can see.

This movement does not provoke opportunity attacks.

LEVEL 4: ABILITY SCORE IMPROVEMENT

You gain the Ability Score Improvement feat (see chapter 4) or another feat of your choice for which you qualify. You gain this feature again at Hunter Zealot levels 8, 12, and 16.

LEVEL 5: RITE AND BLADE

You can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the Attack Action on your turn.

In addition, when you use your Action to perform a Whisper, you can make one weapon attack as a Bonus Action.

LEVEL 6: FANATICAL FOCUS

Your devotion shields your mind from hesitation, fear, and pain.

When you fail a saving throw, you can expend one Strain to reroll the saving throw. You must use the new roll.

If the new roll succeeds, you can immediately move up to half your Speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

LEVEL 10: ZEALOUS PRESENCE

As a Bonus Action, you unleash a command filled with the authority of your Patron.

Choose up to eight creatures of your choice within 60 feet that can see or hear you. Until the start of your next turn, each chosen creature has Advantage on attack rolls and saving throws.

Once you use this feature, you cannot use it again until you finish a Long Rest, unless you expend one Strain to use it again.

LEVEL 19: EPIC BOON

You gain an Epic Boon feat (see chapter 4) or another feat of your choice for which you qualify.

LEVEL 20: ABSOLUTE UNION

As a Bonus Action, you allow your Patron to fully manifest through your body. This transformation lasts for 5 rounds, until you drop to 0 Hit Points, or until you end it early as a Bonus Action.

Once you use this feature, you cannot use it again until you finish a Long Rest.

When you enter this form, you suffer 20 Madness.

While transformed, you gain the following benefits:

Patron's Form. Your body becomes a living vessel for your Patron. Your eyes turn black like the abyss, blackened veins spread across your flesh, impossible shadows cling to your body, bone spines tear through your skin, and spectral limbs writhe around you as if guided by a will beyond your own. When you transform, each other creature within a 30-foot-radius Sphere centered on you must make a Wisdom saving throw against your Rite Save DC.

On a failed save, a creature takes 8d10 Mind damage and suffers 6 Madness. On a successful save, a creature takes half as much damage and suffers 2 Madness.

Each other creature within 120 feet that can see your transformation unfold, but is outside the 30-foot-radius Sphere, suffers 2 Madness.

Eldritch Resistance. You have Immunity to Mind damage and Resistance to Eldritch Power damage.

Unshaken Vessel. You cannot be Frightened, Charmed, Paralyzed, or Stunned.

Devoted Assault. The first time you hit a creature on each of your turns with a weapon attack or Eldritch Strike, the target takes an extra 4d8 Eldritch Power damage.

Lashing Tendrils. As an Action, you command the spectral limbs of your Patron to lash out.

Choose up to three creatures you can see within 30 feet of you. Each target must make a Strength saving throw against your Rite Save DC.

On a failed save, a target takes 6d10 Eldritch Power damage and gains the Restrained condition.

On a successful save, a target takes half as much damage and is not Restrained.

A Restrained creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the condition on itself on a success.

You cannot use Lashing Tendrils again while a creature is Restrained by this feature.

Tendril Reprisal. When a creature within 15 feet of you hits you with an attack, you can take a Reaction to lash out with a spectral tendril. The creature takes 3d10 Eldritch Power damage and must succeed on a Strength saving throw against your Rite Save DC or have the Restrained condition until the end of its next turn.

Unbroken Vessel. If you would drop to 0 Hit Points while this transformation is active, you can expend one Strain to drop to 1 Hit Point instead.

If you drop to 0 Hit Points and do not use this benefit, the transformation ends.